

The Trial (grade 6 edition) — play-through review

Theme `the_trial_ms` · middle-school reasoning about evidence, grade 6 · 10 days, 30 stops · reviewed 2026-08-21 by reading `books/the-trial-ms.yml` in full, working every board, and comparing against the parent `the_trial`.

Verdict

The most surprising campaign in the junior set: a clinical trial's standard of proof, at grade 6, and it works. `per-day` is `[3,3,3,3,3,3,3,3,3]`. **5 of 5 syllabus relations computed. Zero select-only concepts. Zero rows in any debt file.** `questionLoad` reports 5 of 30 demanding stops (17%), all board-size notes. Twelve distinct formats in thirty stops, including a TRACE, an ATTEST, a DEGENERACY and a DELEGATE.

The four boards are the parent's arithmetic simplified without being weakened: $14.5 \div 5 = 2.9$ people screened for each one enrolled; $0.140 \div 0.200 = 0.70$ as assigned against $0.121 \div 0.201 = 0.60$ among completers, which is intention-to-treat versus per-protocol delivered as two divisions; the events-so-far fraction; and the how-often-something-clears-the-line-by-luck multiplicity board.

The opening card is the best statement of a symmetric-risk decision at any level in this catalogue, and it survives the derivation intact: *"Stop it early on a result that turns out to be luck, and a drug that works is buried for ten years. Carry on too long, and everybody who joins after today is in a trial that already had its answer."* Two errors, both costed, in two sentences, at grade 6.

And the ending refuses to be comfortable. The board carries on to the full 380 events; the doctor-written symptom score comes out of the main result *because the guessing survey showed it could not be trusted*; four people in every hundred are better off, which is one helped for every twenty-eight treated. Then: "the symptom score, which was the thing patients cared most about and the thing the trial could no longer stand behind", and nine people told they may have had weakened doses, "which is a hard letter to receive".

Answerable: 30/30. **Sense:** Excellent. The blinding leak explains three earlier days, as in the parent. **Level:** Right, and written against the gate from the first stop. **Fun:** Good, in the quietest register in the junior set.

Implemented since this review

- **TM-01**, the two damaged titles.
- **TM-05**, the opening card now names Dr. Miriam Feldman.

Everything else in the findings table below is unchanged, and `npm run check` is green on this theme.

Findings

ID	Sev	Where	Issue	Proposed fix
TM-01	FIX	Two stop titles	Numeral damage in titles , both inherited from the parent and both present in <code>the_trial_hs</code> as well: "40 hours before the lock" and "3 days, 41	"Forty hours before the lock"; "Three days, forty-one

			queries" . Six damaged titles across three editions from one pair of sentences. A title is read on the plan card, on the map and above the question.	queries". Six edits across three books. Cross-campaign §1.
TM-02	WORTH	Authored background , 3 of 30 stops missing	Thirty guides, twenty-seven backgrounds. Three gaps in an otherwise complete campaign.	Close the three.
TM-03	WORTH	Zero – Review variants	No spaced retrieval, unlike its two sibling well-written editions (redsand_ms and sightline_ms , nine variants each). This is the one thing separating the_trial_ms from those two. Cross-campaign §9.	Three or four variants. The day-2 prespecification idea and the day-7 missing-data idea are the two a child will not hold from a single serving.
TM-04	TASTE	Numeral damage, 4 prose occurrences	"1 feature", "1 duplicated", "1 of", "1 says". Minimal.	Editorial pass.
TM-05	TASTE	opening:	Names nobody. The parent's does not either. Both are otherwise the best-written openings in the set, and Feldman and Balogun run the whole fortnight.	One clause. Cross-campaign §8.

What the derivation did well

- **It kept prespecification as the subject.** "You wrote down what counted before you looked" is the closing paragraph's first claim, and it is the whole course.
- **Intention-to-treat as two divisions.** 0.70 as assigned against 0.60 among completers, and the campaign says which one the trial is entitled to report.
- **It kept the cost.** A grade-6 campaign that ends by naming what was dropped, and why, and what that cost patients.
- **"Nobody knows whether the drug helps the over-seventies more, and after all this the only honest answer is that a bigger trial would have to ask."** An unfinished item that is a refusal to conclude, at grade 6.

Opening and closing

Opening: 106 words, both errors named and costed. TM-05 is its one gap.

Closing: three paragraphs, all three doing work. Keep.

Warm-ups

Authored for this edition. No findings.